

BELKA ENRICHMENT CENTRE

Strategic Growth Overview — Grant Opportunities — Action Plan
Ontario • May 2026

Who We Are — 20 Years of Impact

Belka Enrichment Centre has served the Jane & Finch community since 2003, operating across three cities with multiple programs serving thousands of community members annually.

20+ Years Operating	3 Cities Served	7+ Active Programs	1000s Lives Impacted
Since 2003	Toronto, Brampton, Sudbury	Food, youth, seniors & more	Annually across all programs

Belka sits at the centre of one of Toronto’s highest-need communities. The data justifies every grant we apply for.

The Community Need — Why This Work Matters

Real data from Statistics Canada and PROOF (2024) shows the scale of what we are addressing:

Statistic	Number
Canadians living in food-insecure households (2024)	10 million
Children under 18 affected by food insecurity	2.5 million
Toronto households experiencing food insecurity	24.9%
Marginalized communities (Jane & Finch est.)	40%+
Female lone-parent families food insecure	52.1%

Our Programs — A Multi-Grant Advantage

Running multiple programs is a strategic funding advantage — we qualify for grant categories that single-program organizations cannot access:

Program	Who It Serves	Grants It Unlocks
Food Bank / Mobile Distribution	Families, seniors, isolated residents	Feed Ontario, Food Banks Canada, Local Food Infrastructure Fund

Program	Who It Serves	Grants It Unlocks
Summer Youth Camp	Children & youth ages 6–18	OTF Youth Opportunities, CIBC, Canada Summer Jobs
Seniors Wellness Programs	Adults 55+	Seniors Community Grant, New Horizons for Seniors
Mentoring & High School Programs	At-risk youth	OTF Seed/Grow, TD Capacity Building
NEW: Disability Feeding Program	Disabled adults, homebound seniors	EASE Grant, Local Food Infrastructure Fund
NEW: School Lunch Program (2 communities)	School-age children	National School Food Program, FRESH Grant

URGENT: The EASE Grant deadline is May 7, 2026. Belka qualifies. TPON registration must happen immediately — it takes up to 5 business days to process.

Accessibility — EASE Grant (Immediate Opportunity) – This was based on my visit yesterday. Not sure about the condition of summer camp

Belka currently has documented accessibility barriers:

- Restroom at main Jane & Finch location is not fully accessible for wheelchair users and mobility-impaired individuals
- Summer camp venues have accessibility challenges for participants with mobility needs (need to verify)
- These barriers prevent disabled community members from fully participating in our programs

The EASE Grant funds exactly these improvements — up to \$60,000, covering 100% of eligible costs:

- **Accessible washroom retrofit — widened doorways, grab bars, turning radius**
- **Automatic door openers — at main entrance and key interior doors**
- **Camp venue accessibility — pathways, ramps, accessible seating areas**

Note: We could prioritize improvements we own, and use portable accessibility solutions for temporary spaces

ACTION NEEDED ASAP: Register for a Transfer Payment Ontario (TPON) account at tpon.gov.on.ca. Registration takes up to 5 business days, must be done immediately to meet the May 7 deadline.

TPON Registration — What We Need (10 minutes):

- Go to tpon.gov.on.ca and create an Ontario.ca login
- Register Belka using: CRA Business Number + Legal incorporation name
- Add two contacts (founder as senior signatory)
- Once registered, we handle the rest of the application writing

Full Grant Pipeline — 2026

Grant	Amount	Deadline	Status	Notes
EASE Grant (Accessibility)	Up to \$60K	MAY 7, 2026	URGENT	Register TPON today
OTF Seed Grant	Up to \$100K	July 22 – Aug 19, 2026	Apply Soon	Food bank + youth programs
Feed Ontario	Varies	Rolling	Open Now	Join as member first
TD Canada (Ready Commitment)	\$1K–\$1M+	4x per year	Open Now	Apply via td.com/ca
Local Food Infrastructure Fund	Up to 100%	Check AAFC	Check Now	Funds vehicle/Sienna
Canada Summer Jobs	100% wages	Annual (Jan)	Plan Now	Funds summer camp staff
CIBC Foundation	\$5K–\$50K	Q2 2026	Coming Soon	Youth + food + education focus
Brookfield Partners Foundation	\$3K–\$50K	Rolling	Open Now	Written request required
National School Food Program	Varies	Jun 25, 2026	Register Now	School lunch program
OTF Grow Grant	\$100K–\$600K	Oct 7 – Nov 4, 2026	Phase 2	After Seed Grant approved

Funder Profiles — Key Details

1. OTF — Seed Grant

Detail	Information
Funding Range	\$10,000 – \$100,000 (for 6 to 12 months)
Next Deadline	July 22 – August 19, 2026 at 5:00 p.m. ET
Eligible Activities	Organizational planning, piloting new programs, capacity building for future services
Eligible Sectors	Human and social services, sports & recreation, arts & culture, environment
Key Requirement	CRA-registered charity or incorporated not-for-profit, operating 12+ months in Ontario
Application Portal	OTF Granting Portal at otf.ca
Belka Fit	Excellent — food bank, youth mentoring, and seniors programs all qualify under human and social services

2. OTF — Grow Grant

Detail	Information
Funding Range	\$100,000 – \$600,000 total over 2–3 years (\$50K–\$200K per year)
Next Deadline	October 7 – November 4, 2026 at 5:00 p.m. ET
Focus	Expand, improve, or adapt an existing program or service with a proven track record
Eligible Sectors	Human and social services (primary fit for Belka), sports & recreation, arts & culture, environment
Key Requirement	Established program with demonstrated success and community need
Strategy	Apply for Seed Grant first (Fall 2026), then Grow Grant in subsequent cycle
Belka Fit	Excellent — food bank and youth programs have 20+ year track record of community benefit

3. TD Bank — TD Ready Commitment

Detail	Information
Funding Range	Under \$1,000 to over \$1,000,000 — reviewed based on scope and community impact
Deadlines	Four rounds per year. Applications are reviewed on a rolling basis through the portal
Focus Areas	Financial Security, Connected Communities, Better Health, Vibrant Planet
What TD Looks For	Measurable outcomes, community impact, leadership reflecting community diversity
Eligibility	Canadian registered charities and non-profits. Faith-based orgs may qualify if services are community-wide
Apply	Via td.com/ca — Corporate Donations and Sponsorships portal. If you miss a deadline, your application rolls to the next round automatically
Note	TD prefers that its donation does not exceed 20% of the organization's total operating budget
Belka Fit	Strong — youth programs, food security, and Jane & Finch's status as an underserved community are all direct matches

4. CIBC Foundation

Detail	Information
Funding Streams	(1) Inclusive Communities — education/employment access for underserved groups (2) Children & Youth — ages 13 and under, healthy living, education, enrichment (3) Financial Education — literacy and confidence programs

Detail	Information
Financial Education Deadline	Accepted year-round; reviewed March through October
Eligibility	Canadian registered charities, not-for-profits, or qualified donees with sustainable funding models and measurable impact
Apply	Via CIBC's Donations & Sponsorship portal at cibc.com
Belka Fit	Strong — summer youth camp (ages 6–18), mentoring programs, and Jane & Finch food security all qualify under multiple CIBC streams

5. Brookfield Partners Foundation

Detail	Information
Funding Range	\$3,000–\$50,000 (based on past grants: \$3K–\$50K to Toronto organizations)
Application Type	Written request only — no formal online portal
Deadlines	Rolling — submit anytime
Geographic Focus	Primarily Toronto, Ontario
What to Include	Organization name, address, phone; charitable registration number; contact name and title; brief project description; amount sought; how the donation will be used; who will benefit
Send to	Brookfield Partners Foundation, 300–181 Bay Street, Toronto, ON M5J 2T3
Belka Fit	Good — community health and social service focus aligns with Belka's food and youth programs in Toronto

Food Ecosystem Partners

6. Daily Bread Food Bank — Member Agency Network

Detail	Information
What They Offer	Food supply (fresh and shelf-stable), food program infrastructure, joint advocacy, and public reporting through the annual Who's Hungry report
Membership	Belka can apply to become a member agency — giving access to food distribution and the network's credibility
Headquarters	191 New Toronto Street, Toronto (South Etobicoke) — a 108,000 sq. ft. distribution hub
Strategic Value	Member status strengthens grant applications to Feed Ontario, Food Banks Canada, and federal food security funders
Action	Contact Daily Bread directly to inquire about member agency application at dailybread.ca

Three New Programs — The Growth Strategy

Program 1: Accessible Restroom & Space Retrofits (EASE Grant)

Fix existing accessibility barriers at the Jane & Finch main location and summer camp venues. Directly serves disabled and elderly community members who currently cannot fully access Belka’s programs. Fundable immediately through the EASE Grant (deadline May 7, 2026). This conclusion was made from my visit today. I stand to be corrected

- Accessible washroom retrofit: widened doorways, grab bars, proper turning radius
- Automatic door openers at main entrance and key interior doors
- Camp venue accessibility: pathways, ramps, accessible seating areas
- Estimated cost: up to \$60,000 — 100% covered by EASE Grant

Program 2: Disability Feeding Program (see what AODA policy apply)

Home delivery of cooked and uncooked food hampers to disabled adults and isolated seniors in Jane & Finch. Modelled on successful programs in the USA (Project DASH), UK, and Australia. Requires a vehicle (truck or Sienna) : fundable through the Local Food Infrastructure Fund and Feed Ontario’s Feeding Possibility grant. We can also streamline this to our Africa or Nigeria community if too robust

- Target population: 20–50 clients initially, with weekly delivery
- Service: groceries + prepared meals for homebound individuals
- Vehicle requirement: fundable through Local Food Infrastructure Fund
- Aligns with CIBC Inclusive Communities and TD Connected Communities funding streams

Program 3: School Lunch Program (2 Ontario Communities – as discussed in the car, can be more)

Provide nutritious lunches to students at 2 underserved schools in Belka’s operating communities. Backed by Swedish research showing children in school lunch programs earn 3% more lifetime income and have measurably better health outcomes. Canada’s National School Food Program Act was enshrined in law in March 2026 — federal funding is now available.

- Pilot: 1–2 schools, 50–150 students, 2–3 days per week
- Strong federal backing through National School Food Program (deadline Jun 25, 2026)
- Evidence base: Swedish longitudinal research links school meals to 3% lifetime income gain
- Potential to expand to Brampton and Sudbury locations in Year 2

Data & Grant Readiness

Strong applications require current, accurate program data. The following metrics should be tracked and documented for every grant we plan to submit:

Data to Collect	Why It Matters
Participants per program (monthly)	Demonstrates scale and community reach
Meals/hampers distributed	Quantifies food security impact for food-focused grants
Demographics (youth, seniors, disabled, newcomers)	Shows alignment with funder priorities and community need

Data to Collect	Why It Matters
Outcomes & impact stories	Required for OTF, TD, and CIBC applications
Geographic data (postal codes served)	Proves service in high-need areas like Jane & Finch

I can build an automated grant tracking (deadlines, status), create reusable application content, and build future dashboards and reporting systems. This infrastructure pays dividends across every future grant application.

Action Plan based on decision

This Week	This Month	This Quarter
• Register TPON account ASAP (tpon.gov.on.ca) • Gather CRA number + incorporation docs • Get contractor quote for restroom • Submit EASE application by May 7	• Submit 2-3 more grant applications • Apply to Feed Ontario (join as member) • Apply to TD Canada Ready Commitment • Build grant-ready document folder • Contact Daily Bread about membership	• Apply for OTF Seed Grant (Jul 22) • Start disability feeding program design • Submit school lunch program proposal • Write Brookfield Partners Foundation letter • Prepare OTF Grow Grant for Fall 2026